

1971

JAN 30–MAR 25

In Operation Lam Son 719, some 20,000 ARVN troops invade Laos with American support, aiming to cut the Ho Chi Minh Trail. They eventually withdraw having suffered heavy casualties.



Returning sniper fire while on patrol, January 1971

MARCH 29

A military court finds William Calley guilty of murdering 22 Vietnamese civilians in the My Lai Massacre.

MAY 1–5

A series of nonviolent acts of civil disobedience by antiwar militants in Washington, D.C. results in 12,000 arrests.

JUNE 13

The publication of leaked Defense Department documents about the war begins. They are known as the Pentagon Papers.

SEPT 5–OCT 8

Operation Jefferson Glenn, inland from Hue and Da Nang, is the last major combat operation in which US ground troops take part.

OCTOBER 2

Thieu is re-elected unopposed as South Vietnamese president.

OCTOBER 3

Cambodian government troops launch an offensive against Vietnamese communist and Khmer Rouge forces.